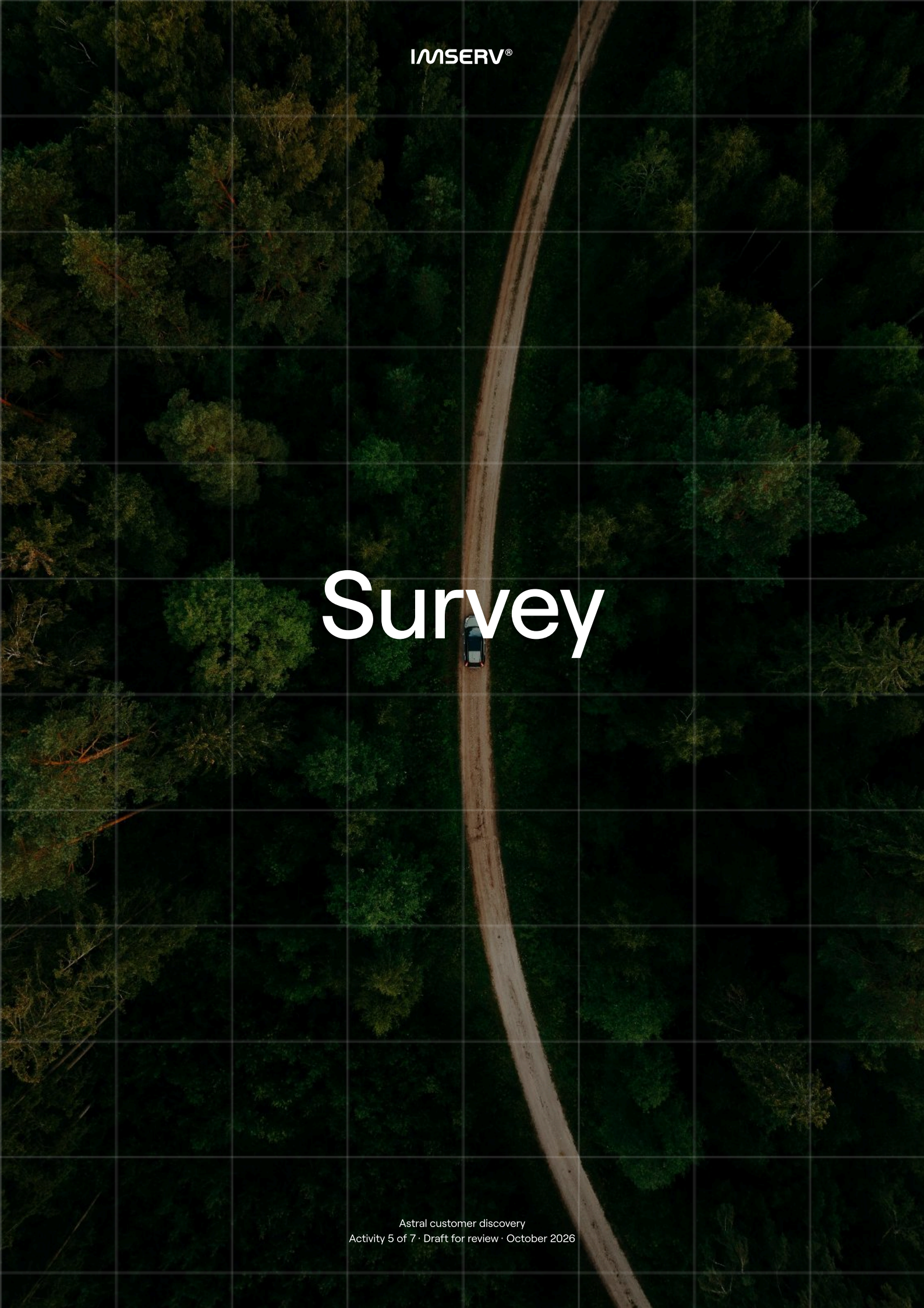
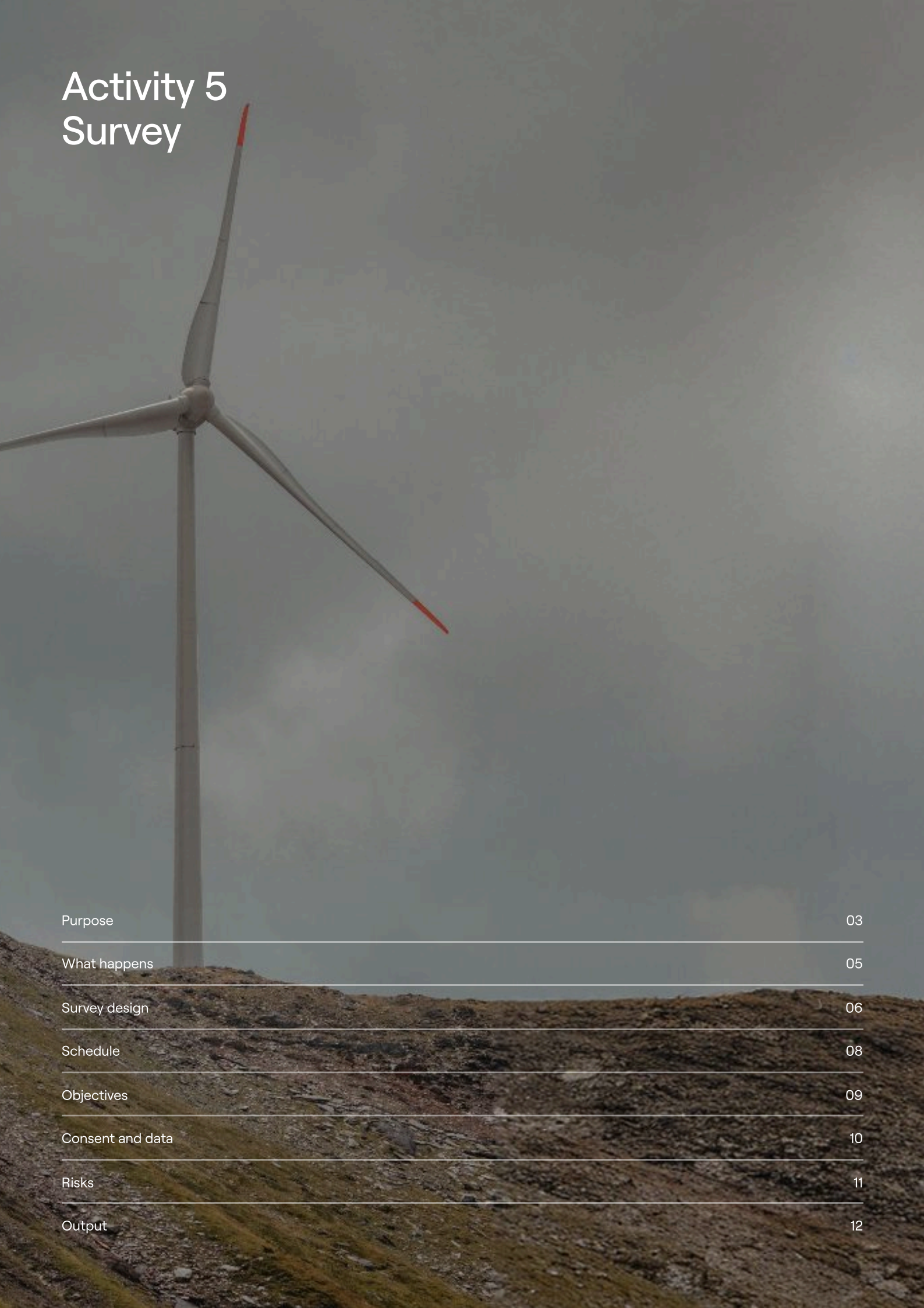
IMSERV®



Survey

Astral customer discovery
Activity 5 of 7 · Draft for review · October 2026

Activity 5
Survey



Purpose 03

What happens 05

Survey design 06

Schedule 08

Objectives 09

Consent and data 10

Risks 11

Output 12

ACTIVITY 5 OF 7

Survey

Gauge how often the patterns from discovery happen across a wider group of respondents.

PROVISIONAL DURATION

3 to 4 weeks

DEPENDS ON

Distribution route. Reachable population known

OUTPUT

Reported patterns across respondents, with sampling limits stated.

OBJECTIVES IT SERVES

- 3. **Understand** what people check before they trust and share a figure or a report.
- 6. **Gauge** how often the patterns from interviews happen across a wider group of respondents.

THE SEVEN ACTIVITIES

1	Agree scope and decisions
2	Set up recruitment
3	Discovery round 1
4	Discovery round 2, targeted
5	**Survey**
6	Integrate and follow up
7	Test design implications

PRIMARY RESEARCH QUESTION

How do IMSERV customers do their energy-data work today, and which differences in that work should change how Astral is designed and prioritised?

IMSERV®

What happens

What happens

Gauge how often the patterns from discovery happen across a wider group of respondents.

1

Build from discovery

Build questions from discovery findings, in customers' own words.

2

Ask about behaviour

Ask about behaviour, not about which persona someone is.

3

Pilot

Pilot with target users to check meaning, answer options, and effort.

4

Run and analyse

Run, then analyse.

Ask about behaviour

Build questions from discovery findings, in customers' own words. Ask about behaviour, not about which persona someone is.

Ask this	Not this
In the past three months, how often have you compared figures from more than one source before sharing a report?	Are you an evidence-led analyst?

Rules

- A recall period that fits each activity. Monthly reporting and annual processes need different treatment
- Include “not applicable” and “don't know”. Keep them apart from missing answers
- Wording, options, and order change results
- Set the response target only after we know the reachable population, sampling approach, and comparisons needed
- Results describe **respondents** unless the sampling supports wider claims
- Report people and customer organisations separately
- More responses do not remove recruitment bias

Why not start with the survey

A survey written before discovery measures our own assumptions. It may:

- miss activities customers think are important
- use words that do not match how people describe their work
- force people into categories that do not fit
- collect feature wishes instead of explaining needs

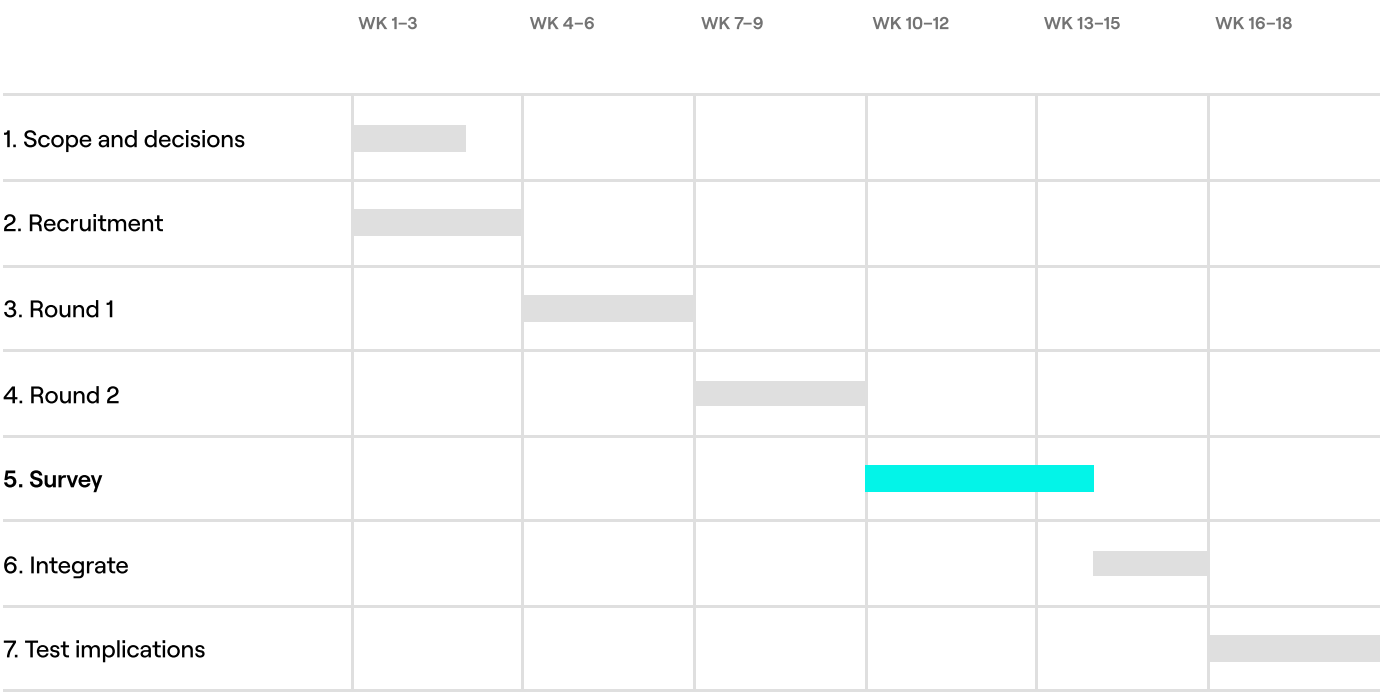
IMSERV®



Plan and safeguards

Where it sits

Estimates to agree, not commitments. Bars show the upper estimate for each stage. With overlap, roughly 12 to 18 weeks from agreement to tested implications.



Stage	Provisional duration	Depends on
5. Survey	3 to 4 weeks	Distribution route. Reachable population known

Objective-to-evidence

How this activity answers the objectives. Measures serve an objective. They are not collected for their own sake.

Objective	Research question	Evidence	Measure
3. Understand	What do people check before relying on a figure?	Described and shown checks. Reported frequency	Reported frequency among respondents
6. Gauge	How often do these patterns happen?	Responses	Share of respondents, by people and by organisation

Neutral draft. No consent wording is sent until it is approved. Legal review before it reaches a participant.

Consent, privacy and data

Agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session.

Every session

- Informed consent for every participant before the session
- Recording, transcription, storage, retention, and any AI processing agreed with IMSERV's privacy and data-protection owner before the first session
- Approved storage with restricted access. Raw recordings and transcripts stay restricted
- Customer documents shown in walkthroughs are redacted or not kept, as agreed
- Participants are P01, P02 in analysis. Removing names alone may not anonymise a distinctive business account
- Quotes in shared outputs only with consent for anonymised quotation
- No consent wording is sent until it is approved. The current wording is a neutral draft

How AI is used

Copilot can help organise approved material, suggest candidate patterns, and keep evidence links up to date. Only within what the privacy owner approves.

It will **not** invent quotes, build archetypes from job titles, or treat simulated customers as evidence.

Risks and limits

What could weaken the evidence, and what we do about it.

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
The survey reaches only engaged customers	Patterns look more common than they are	Report respondents, not customers. Name the sampling limits
Participants come from one or two organisations	Shared local process looks like a pattern	Track organisation coverage. Recruit across several

Reported patterns across respondents, with sampling limits stated.

Output

Early findings reach the BA team from round 1, not only at the end.

Hands over to

Activity 6. Integrate and follow up.

Bring the evidence together, investigate disagreement, and refine archetypes and journeys.

Working alongside the BA team

- Round 1 findings are shared with the BA team as they emerge, marked provisional
- Stories link back to the need and evidence behind them
- The BA team (Claire and others) can bring open story questions into round 2



Thank You

Shaun Leishman
UX, IMSERV